UNIT 1 · TOPIC 7(E)

Potato Equipment

Syllabus topic: Special equipment for crops: vegetables, sugarcane, cotton, groundnut, potato and fruit crops

Planting

Potato planter	Mechanism
Cup-belt type	Vertical belt with cups.
Picker-wheel type	Pins pierce the tubers — causes some damage.

Potato planters plant on ridges and come as automatic and semi-automatic types.

Harvesting — elevator digger

1. The **share** lifts the ridge onto the conveyor.
2. An **agitated rod-link chain conveyor** sifts out the soil.

- Spinner/blade diggers are simpler designs.
- A **potato combine** adds a picking table.

Practice MCQs

Q31. The picker-wheel type potato planter's main drawback is:

(a) Low capacity (b) Tuber damage by piercing picks
(c) Cannot form ridges (d) High draft

Q60. In an elevator-type potato digger, soil separation is achieved by:

(a) Blower (b) Agitated rod-link chain conveyor
(c) Washing (d) Sieves and fan

Answers

Q31 — (b) Tuber damage by piercing picks

Q60 — (b) Agitated rod-link chain conveyor